

THE FRAMEWORK

Pause. Pivot. Point.

Move Like Olajuwon
PRACTICE THE MOVE BEFORE YOU NEED IT



You already know what's coming. List the moments that happen in your room or building, then practice the move here, before it happens there.

1

Pause
Catch the reaction you'd normally have, and hold it.

→

2

Pivot
Choose a different move than the one they expect.

→

3

Point
Remember what the moment is actually for.

Event What happens?	01 Pause My common reaction, the one I hold back	02 Pivot My new reaction	03 Point What lesson do I want to accomplish?	! Pitfalls Easy traps to fall into
A				
B				
C				
D				
E				



Top Ten Things You May Not Say In My Office

- 1 *I didn't do anything.*
- 2 *Everybody else was doing it.*
- 3 *I didn't know that was a rule.*
- 4 *We were just playing.*
- 5 *He/she started it.*
- 6 *He/she made me do it.*
- 7 *It's the teacher's fault.*
- 8 *Can't I have a warning?*
- 9 *I barely touched him.*
- 10 *It was an accident.*

THE STORY

I made this in 1999, three weeks into my first assistant principal job. It's the most common excuses, all in one frame, and it has saved me a fortune in time.

HOW IT WORKS

A student walks in and opens with, *"I wasn't even doing anything."* I tell them to read the picture. Then I say something like, *"You should have been doing your math."*

When they say, *"I can't even say anything,"* I usually tell them: *"You can tell me what you did."*

✦ *The sign doesn't end the conversation. It skips to the part that matters.* ✦

— FROM THE OFFICE WALL • SINCE 1995

Mission *Statement*



“

I will affect every student I see in a positive manner.

I will strive to ensure the success of the instructors of my school in their teaching endeavors.

I will make any necessary changes to increase the number and quality of opportunities for my students.

I will regard every moment as a teachable moment, either for myself or my students.

I wrote this in 1995 as part of a college assignment. It still holds true. Having something like this on your wall is a great self-reminder to stay focused on what is important.

✦ *Thirty-one years later, I haven't needed to change a word.* ✦

YOUR TURN

Write Yours

Start every sentence with "I will." Four sentences or fewer: one for the people you serve, one for the people you support, one for what you'll change, one for how you'll keep learning.

I will

I will

I will

I will

— THE MOTTO • 30 LINES WORTH KEEPING

I have value. My life has a purpose. I will succeed.

"Many people do not fail because they lack potential. They fail because they lose sight of their value, their purpose, or the possibility of success."

♥ I Have Value

01 – 10

- 01 Children deserve a great life not by their actions but by grace.
- 02 Being overlooked is not the same as being unimportant.
- 03 I did not want stigma to speak first. I wanted dignity to speak first.
- 04 Nobody is too far gone to be worth the walk.
- 05 Not how are your grades. How are you.
- 06 You were valuable before anyone noticed. You'll still be valuable after they forget.
- 07 Your worst day is not your whole story.
- 08 Your value was settled before you walked in the door. Today is about what you do with it.
- 09 A label tells you where someone is. It never tells you what they're worth.
- 10 The room changes when one person decides you matter. Be that person.

🕒 My Life Has a Purpose

11 – 20

- 11 Purpose is not a destination. It is a direction.
- 12 You don't have to see your whole purpose to take the next right step toward it.
- 13 Your purpose is not a job. It is a direction. And directions work in more vehicles than you think.
- 14 The hard part of your story might be the part someone else needs to hear.
- 15 Purpose does not change. Our understanding of it deepens.
- 16 Purpose shows up in small places first. One class. One kid. One conversation.
- 17 Sometimes the worst things that happen to us become our best stories later in life.
- 18 You are not here by accident. Live like it.
- 19 Where you start doesn't decide where you're headed.
- 20 Someone is watching how you handle today. That's part of your purpose too.

📈 I Will Succeed

21 – 30

- 21 The greater the struggle, the more opportunity you have to rise.
- 22 One good period can start a good day. One good day can start a good week.
- 23 Success happens in private moments of decision, long before the world sees it.
- 24 You don't need a perfect day. You need a better minute.
- 25 Finishing something hard is proof of who you are.
- 26 Don't measure yourself against the finish line. Measure yourself against yesterday.
- 27 Small wins are not small. They are practice.
- 28 Every big win is made of small ones nobody clapped for.
- 29 You showed up today. That counts.
- 30 Celebrate the step. Stairs only get climbed one at a time.



♥ I HAVE VALUE

The Cut-Up Game

The opposite of the cut-down game.

HOW TO PLAY

Take turns finishing "You are so _____ that..." with a compliment instead of a cut-down. Building self-worth, one line at a time.

RULES

- No backhanded compliments.
- The person receiving it has to look up and say "thank you."

EXAMPLE

*"You are so smart that the calculator asks
you for help."*

Write three for someone in your room _____

You are so _____ that...

FOR: _____

You are so _____ that...

FOR: _____

You are so _____ that...

FOR: _____



♥ I HAVE VALUE

The Gratitude Game

Who can make the longest list?

☀ SET A TIMER

3 minutes. List everything
you're grateful for.

+1 POINT

For every item on your list.

-1 POINT

If you list something twice.

01	16
02	17
03	18
04	19
05	20
06	21
07	22
08	23
09	24
10	25
11	26
12	27
13	28
14	29
15	30

ITEMS

—

REPEATS

=

MY SCORE



🕒 MY LIFE HAS A PURPOSE

The Job Game

List them. Rank them. Compare. Revise.

- 1 • LIST
-
- 2 • RANK
-
- 3 • COMPARE
-
- 4 • REVISE

List every job you can think of. Rank your top ten: the ones you'd most want to do. Compare your list to a friend's. Then revise.

My List	EVERY JOB	My Top Ten	RANKED	After Comparing	REVISED
		1		1	
		2		2	
		3		3	
		4		4	
		5		5	
		6		6	
		7		7	
		8		8	
		9		9	
		10		10	

What did your friend's list make you notice?



I WILL SUCCEED

The Success Game

Success comes in small pieces.

Check every box you've done **this week**, then count your score.

- | | |
|---|--|
| 01 ☐ Woke up | 11 ☐ Helped someone without being asked |
| 02 ☐ Got to school or work on time | 12 ☐ Went to bed on time |
| 03 ☐ Told a parent or caretaker I love them | 13 ☐ Learned something new |
| 04 ☐ Improved a score on a quiz or test | 14 ☐ Asked for help when I needed it |
| 05 ☐ Held the door for someone | 15 ☐ Made someone laugh |
| 06 ☐ Lent a friend some money (even a nickel counts) | 16 ☐ Paused instead of reacting |
| 07 ☐ Ate breakfast | 17 ☐ Finished something I started |
| 08 ☐ Turned in an assignment or finished a task | 18 ☐ Cleaned up a mess I didn't make |
| 09 ☐ Said thank you to someone who didn't expect it | 19 ☐ Read something just for fun |
| 10 ☐ Apologized when I was wrong | 20 ☐ Gave someone a compliment |
| + ☐ _____ | + ☐ _____ |

MY SCORE

/ 20

Every box is a success. Most people score higher than they think they will.



— THEIR WORLD • TEST 1 OF 2

The Rap Test

Ten questions your students could answer in their sleep.

**PART 1** Finish the Name

01 Rod _____

02 NBA Young _____

03 Ice _____

04 Lil _____ Vert

05 Playboi _____

PART 2 Match the Song to the Rapper *Draw a line.*

06 "Yeah Glo!"

☐ Kendrick Lamar

07 "Sprinter"

☐ DoeChii

08 "Mmmmm"

☐ GloRilla

09 "Anxiety"

☐ BigXthaPlug

10 "Not Like Us"

☐ Central CeeSONG
→
RAPPER**8 – 10**

They'd let you in the group chat.

4 – 7

You're trying.

0 – 3

Time to ask a student.

We expect students to learn the things we value. Have we learned anything about the things they value?

Show your kids you care by exploring their world.

TIP Take the test, then hand it to a student and let them grade you.

ANSWER KEY • 1 Wave • 2 Boy • 3 Spice • 4 Uzi • 5 Cardi • 6 GloRilla • 7 Central Cee • 8 BigXthaPlug • 9 DoeChii • 10 Kendrick Lamar

— THEIR WORLD • TEST 2 OF 2

The Game Test



Ten questions your students could answer with the controller in their hands.

PART 1 Finish It

- 01 **FORTNITE** Win the match and you get a Victory _____ .
- 02 **FORTNITE** Every match starts by jumping out of the Battle _____ .
- 03 **MINECRAFT** The green mob that sneaks up and explodes is a _____ .
- 04 **NBA 2K** To steal the ball on PlayStation, press _____ .
- 05 **NBA 2K** The secret codes that unlock free rewards are _____ Codes.

PART 2 Match the Money to the Game Draw a line.

06 **V-Bucks**07 **Robux**08 **VC**09 **COD Points**10 **FC Points**

MONEY
→
GAME

● **Call of Duty**● **NBA 2K**● **EA Sports FC**● **Fortnite**● **Roblox****8 – 10**

You've got next.

4 – 7

You're on the bench.

0 – 3

Ask a student for a tutorial.

The Challenge

TEACHER SCORE

/ **10**

Take the test first and post your score where your class can see it. Then hand it out.
Every student who beats your score wins:

- ☐ Candy ☐ 5 bonus points on the next test ☐ Homework pass
☐ First in line for lunch ☐ _____

Losing to your students on purpose is still a win.

They spend hours in these worlds. Spend ten minutes in one of them.

Show your kids you care by exploring their world.

ANSWER KEY • 1 Royale • 2 Bus • 3 Creeper • 4 Square (X on Xbox) • 5 Locker • 6 Fortnite • 7 Roblox • 8 NBA 2K • 9 Call of Duty • 10 EA Sports FC

— THE STORY • EVERY KID HAS ONE

A Pair of *Glasses*



I was an easy A student. My brother started late, and the system was circling special education.

I believe it was when he was in third grade, they realized that he needed glasses. He was incredibly smart. He just couldn't see the board. How crazy is it that just a pair of glasses changed his trajectory?

Years later, as a freshman at a school of 3,500, he got caught smoking behind the cafeteria and was sent to the alternative school. His grades went from C's to A's.

When his time was up, he asked to stay.

THE MORAL

"In a room of a hundred and fifty kids, he could be the best. In a school of thirty-five hundred, there's not always someone there to pat them on the back."

Sometimes the problem isn't the kid. It's what nobody has noticed yet.

YOUR TURN

Your Story Every teacher and every student has one.

MY STORY

MY MORAL

Alternative schools matter. You matter. They matter.
Every single one.